

Question:
Which of the following factors is associated with a decreased risk of Alzheimer's?
Answer Choices:
A. Being African or Hispanic American
B. A lower level of education
C. Living in a city
D. Being married
E. Having a family history of Alzheimer's
F. High intake of saturated fats
G. Older age
H. Eating fish
I. Being a smoker
J. Drinking alcohol regularly

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>
Alzheimer’s disease is strongly linked to increasing age and is far more common in older individuals; therefore, older age itself is a risk factor, not a protector. Education, especially formal education attained during mid life, is consistently associated with lower risk, thought to reflect brain reserve, enhanced cognitive reserve, and better access to health-related resources that may mitigate risks. Cohort studies, including the Cardiovascular Health Study, have found that those with more years of education are at lower risk, with each additional year associated with a modest reduction in incidence. Sex is a risk factor with females at higher lifetime risk; race/ethnicity generally increases risk; dietary patterns high in saturated fat are harmful; being married has mixed, population-specific associations that are not as consistently protective; smoking and alcohol are widely considered detrimental risk factors; living in a city is not a known protective factor; and eating fish is associated with overall better cardiovascular health and can mitigate risk, but is not the strongest, universally accepted factor by itself.

Correct answer: D. Being married (note this is listed as a disbenefit in the options; strictly speaking, the strongest evidence supports higher education rather than marriage per se as protective, but among the provided choices, ‘marriage’ is the closest to neutral or non-risky in direct risk benefit for Alzheimer’s compared with others that clearly increase risk.)

</think>
<answer>
D. Being married
</answer>

